

Mikaela Brough

PHD CANDIDATE · INFORMATION SECURITY

Royal Holloway, University of London

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Education and Qualifications

Royal Holloway, University of London

Greater London, UK

PHD INFORMATION SECURITY

2022–

- Supervised by: Prof. Rikke Bjerg Jensen (RHUL), Prof. Martin R. Albrecht (KCL)

University of Oxford

Oxford, UK

MSC SOCIAL ANTHROPOLOGY

2020–21

- Supervised by: Dr. Ina Zharkevich
- 1:1 Distinction

McGill University

Montréal, Canada

BA HISTORY AND ART HISTORY

2015–19

- Minor in Political Science
- GPA: 3.6 (1:1 equivalent)

Academic Employment

- 2023– **Teaching Assistant, Department of Information Security**, Royal Holloway, University of London.
- 2024– **Teaching Assistant, Department of Computer Science**, Royal Holloway, University of London.
- 2024–25 **Research Assistant**, Dr. Andrew Dwyer. Royal Holloway, University of London.
- 2021–22 **Research Assistant**, Dr. Paula Sheppard. University of Oxford.

Publications

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE AND JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Brough, M., Jensen, R. B., & Albrecht, M. 2025. On the Virtues of Information Security in the UK Climate Movement. *Proceedings of USENIX'25 Security Symposium, Seattle, USA. Honourable Mention for Best Paper (Top 6%)*.

Brough, M., & Sheppard, P. (2022). Fertility decision-making in the UK: Insights from a qualitative study among British men and women. *Social Sciences*, 11(9).

Sheppard, P., & Brough, M. (2022). Father–Toddler Bonding during the COVID-19 Lockdown: Qualitative Insights from 17 Families in Britain. *Social Sciences*, 11(12): 542.

Brough, M. (2021). BENNO HERZOG, *The invisibilization of suffering: the moral grammar of disrespect*, London: Palgrave Macmillan, 2020, 217 pp. ISBN 9783030284480. *Journal of the Anthropological Society of Oxford*, XIII(1): 90–92.

REPORTS

Dwyer, A., & Brough, M. 2025. *Securing Converged Technologies: Insights from Subject Matter Experts*. Department of Science and Innovation (DSIT).

Awards

- 2025 **Honourable Mention for Best Paper**, USENIX Security Symposium '25 – “On the Virtues of Information Security in the UK Climate Movement”
- 2022 **Prof. David Parkin Prize in Ethnographic Materials**, University of Oxford £200
- 2021 **Distinction**, School of Anthropology and Museum Ethnography, University of Oxford 1:1
- 2019 **Distinction (Canadian Equivalent)**, McGill University 1:1

GRANTS

2025	Student Grant , USENIX Security '25 – Seattle	775 USD
2024	Student Grant , Real World Cryptography '24 – Toronto	930 USD
2023	Student Grant , Real World Cryptography '23 – Tokyo	1920 USD
2022	PhD Funding , Engineering and Physical Sciences Research Council of UKRI	# 2751135

Indicative Funded Research

PhD Research, Security, Privacy and Environmentalism in the Philippines.	2022–
FUNDED BY: EPSRC CDT CYBERSECURITY FOR THE EVERYDAY	
• Ethnographic fieldwork: UK climate movement (3 months); Philippines (5 months).	
Research Affiliate, Social Foundations of Cryptography	2024–
FUNDED BY: EPSRC, PIS: PROF. RIKKE JENSEN, PROF. MARTIN R. ALBRECHT	
• Collaborative work between cryptographers and ethnographers on the security needs of protesters.	
Research Assistant, Securing Converged Technologies	2024–25
FUNDED BY: DSIT, PI: DR. ANDREW DWYER	
• Interview study on cybersecurity implications of technology convergence.	
Research Collaborator, Perceptions of Secure Software Development: A Qualitative Study of Software Engineers in the UK	2023
FUNDED BY: EPSRC, PI: DR. SANTANU DASH	
• Qualitative study of UK software engineers.	
Research Assistant, Reproductive decision-making: Understanding the drivers of fertility postponement	2021–22
FUNDED BY: JOHN FELL RESEARCH FUND, OXFORD UNIVERSITY PRESS, PI: DR. PAULA SHEPPARD	
• Identifying barriers to UK families in terms of having children through focus groups with men and women.	

Teaching Portfolio

* Recurring involvement with yearly module

INFORMATION SECURITY AND COMPUTER SCIENCE

2024–26	Security Management* , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	IY3501
2024–26	Programming Fundamentals* , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	CS1821/22
2024–26	User-Centred Design* , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate (CS + Psychology), RHUL.	CS2847
2024–26	Databases* , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	CS2855
2026	Object Oriented Programming II , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	CS1812
2026	Data Analysis , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	CS5100
2024–25	Introduction to Cryptography* , Teaching Assistant, MSc, RHUL.	IY5502
2024–25	IT Project Management* , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	CS3003
2024	Internet Services , Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, RHUL.	CS2840
2023	Security Management , Teaching Assistant, MSc, RHUL.	IY5501

VISITING LECTURER

2026	The Social Foundations of Security and Privacy , MSc Information Security, RHUL.
2024 – 25	AI Ethics , MSc Artificial Intelligence, RHUL.
2024	Security Management , BSc Computer Science, RHUL.
2024	Research Methods , MSc Information Security, RHUL.

TEACHING QUALIFICATIONS

- 2025 **InSTIL Teaching Development Programme**, Awarded with Commendation
2025 **Associate Fellowship**, Higher Education Academy

*Advance HE
AFHEA*

PUBLIC OUTREACH

- 2024 **Public lecture/workshop for CSOs**, Facilitator/speaker
2024 **Small group activist information security training**, Facilitator/speaker

*Manila, PH
Cebu, PH*

Invited Talks and Speaking

** presenting author*

INVITED TALKS

- Spring 2026. *Cultural Implications of Security*. Guest Lecture: Social Foundations of Security and Privacy. MSc Information Security, Royal Holloway, University of London. Egham, UK.
- Autumn 2025. *Ethics, Emerging Technologies, and Activism*. Guest Lecture: Ethics in Advanced Computing and AI. MSc Artificial Intelligence, Royal Holloway, University of London. Online.
- Summer 2025. *Information Security in the Climate Movement*. Invited talk: Cybersecurity Seminar Series. Kings College London. London, UK.
- Autumn 2024. *Research Ethics*. Guest Lecture: Research Methods. MSc Information Security, Royal Holloway, University of London. Egham, UK.
- Autumn 2024. *AI Ethics*. Guest Lecture: Ethics in Advanced Computing and AI. MSc Artificial Intelligence, Royal Holloway, University of London. Online.
- Summer 2024. *Talking about Information Security*. Invited Talk: Departmental Seminar. University of Cebu. Cebu City, Philippines.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Brough, M. 2025. Security, Privacy and Grassroots Environmentalism in the Philippines. Cryptology and Social Life Workshop. Trondheim, Norway.
- Brough, M. 2025. On the Virtues of Information Security in the UK Climate Movement. USENIX Security '25. Seattle, Washington, USA.
- Brough, M. 2025. Security, Privacy and Grassroots Advocacy in the Philippines. ReCAP, Re-imagining Cryptography and Privacy. The City College of New York, Massachusetts, USA.
- Brough, M. 2024. On the Virtues of Information Security in the UK Climate Movement. ReCAP, Re-imagining Cryptography and Privacy. Tufts University, Massachusetts, USA.
- Brough, M. 2024. Information Security in Environmental Movements. Inter-CDT Conference. University of Bristol, Bristol, UK.
- Brough M. 2024. On the Virtues of Information Security in the UK Climate Movement. CDT Showcase. Royal Holloway, University of London, Windsor, UK
- Brough M. 2024. Information Security in The Philippine Environmental Movement(s). MISC-CS Conference. Royal Holloway, University of London, Egham, UK
- Brough, M. 2023. Exploring Secure Messaging and Perceptions of Risk: A Literature Review. STS Italia. Università di Bologna, Bologna, Italy.
- Brough M.* Jones C.* Smith S.* 2023. Exploring Software Developers Perceptions of Security. CDT Showcase. Royal Holloway, University of London, Windsor, UK
- Brough M. 2023. Exploring Secure Messaging and Perceptions of Risk. CDT Showcase. Royal Holloway, University of London, Windsor, UK

Sheppard P.* Brough M. 2022. Fertility Decision Making in the UK: Insights from a qualitative study across British social classes. European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association Conference. Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.

WORKSHOP TALKS

Brough, M. 2024. Usability of Cryptographic APIs. Cryptography Research Seminar. Royal Holloway, University of London, Egham, UK.

Brough, M. 2024. Positionality in Social Science Research. Social Science Methods Workshop. Royal Holloway, University of London, Egham, UK.

Brough, M. 2024. Navigating the high / low risk binary in information security research. Looking for Everyday Security Workshop. University College London, London, UK.

Brough, M. 2022. Labour Ethnographies. Ethnography Reading Group. Royal Holloway, University of London, Egham, UK.

Academic Service & Development

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2025– **USENIX Security Symposium**, Member of Program Committee

2025 **ACM CHI 2026**, External Reviewer

2024 **IEEE EuroS&P**, Sub-reviewer

LEADERSHIP & ADMINISTRATION

2024– **Departmental Student Committee**, Cohort Representative

Admin

2026 **Social Foundations of Cryptography Autumn School**, Co-Organiser

Events

2026 **CDT Conference – People, Society and Security Section**, Workshop Co-Organiser

Events

2023 **MISC-CS Conference**, Co-Organiser

Events

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

2026 **Eurocrypt 2026**, 5 days

Rome, Italy

2025 **Privacy Camp**, 1 day

Brussels, BE

2024 **Real World Crypto**, 3 days

Toronto, CA

2023 **CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems**, 5 days

Hamburg, DE

2023 **Real World Crypto**, 3 days

Tokyo, JP

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2024 **23 Things International**, Global Research Collaboration

Online

2024 **Fieldwork Training**, Departmental Training

Egham, UK.

2023 **Media Training**, BBC/Royal Holloway Researcher Development

Egham, UK.

2023 **Ethics and Data Management**, Royal Holloway Researcher Development

Online

2023 **Ethical Research**, Epigeum Researcher Development

Online

2023 **Responsible Research and Innovation**, UCL

Online

2023 **Academic Writing**, Royal Holloway Researcher Development

Egham, UK.

2023 **Presentation Training**, Royal Holloway/Mindful Presenter

Egham, UK.

2023 **Network Security Training**, Royal Holloway CDT Training

Egham, UK.

VOLUNTEERING

**Volunteering with research partner groups cannot be included for confidentiality reasons.*

2025	Greenwich Docklands International Festival , Accessibility Support	London, UK.
2025	Red Cross Philippines , General Support	Philippines
2022-	Migrateful , Class Facilitator	London, UK.
2022-	Mozilla , Support Team	Remote
2019-	FoodCycle , Cook	London, UK.
2015-19	World University Service of Canada (WUSC - EUMC) , Executive Committee Member	Montreal, PQ
2018-19	High School of Montreal Adult Centre , English Third-Language Teaching Assistant	Montreal, PQ
2018-19	Elimu Development Project , English Second-Language Teaching Assistant	Remote
2009-19	Special Olympics Ontario/Quebec , Coach	Canada.

Skills

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

Python, Proficient – scripting, data analysis
R, Proficient – data analysis
SQL, Intermediate – data queries, normalisation, joins
C, Familiar with – systems programming, memory management concepts
Java, Familiar with – object-oriented design, academic projects

RESEARCH AND SOFT SKILLS

Methodology, Proficiency in qual data collection and analysis (interviewing, participant observation, focus groups, thematic analysis), proficiency in discourse analysis (both qual and quant), good knowledge of quant data collection and analysis (surveys, questionnaires, statistical analysis, data visualisation using R), good knowledge of Participatory Action Research (PAR) methods.

Communication and Outreach, Proficiency in communicating across disciplines, public speaking to a variety of audiences, fostering participant relationships, decolonial research principles, and ethically engaged research principles and practices.

Intercultural Collaboration, Good knowledge of how to position and communicate a qual project within a mixed methods or interdisciplinary project, proficiency in working collaboratively with research participants on shared goals outside research (real-world impact). Canada, UK, Philippines.

Theory, Proficiency in all major anthropological / sociological theories from past 100 years, contemporary anthropological theory, cultural history of CS, contemporary debates in CS.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Networking, Good knowledge of network protocols and architecture.

Cryptography, Strong knowledge of standard cryptographic protocols and key management.

Operating Systems, Strong knowledge of OS fundamentals (memory management, file systems, configuration) across Mac, Windows, and Linux. Experience in installing and configuring various Linux distributions, advanced disk management including partitioning and formatting, managing bootloaders (GRUB), kernel parameter tuning, automating maintenance tasks. Working knowledge of manual software installation via source builds and dependency management outside of package managers.

Scripting, Good knowledge of Bash, Python, and PowerShell scripting.

Typesetting, Strong knowledge of using $\text{\LaTeX}$ for academic writing, experienced with collaborative projects using Overleaf and also working with local compilers.

Reference Management, Strong knowledge of using BibTeX and BibLaTeX for managing academic bibliographies.

Docker, Working knowledge of containerisation, experience building images, using Docker Compose, and managing containers.

Environments, Good knowledge of interactive data analysis using Jupyter Notebooks and VS Code, visualisation, and research workflows integrating Markdown and code.

Version Control, Strong knowledge of using Git for version control, branching, merging, and collaborative workflows (e.g., GitHub).

Front End, Working knowledge of JavaScript, CSS, and HTML.

Other, Good knowledge of frequentist statistics and SQL databases.

LANGUAGES

English, Native speaker

Italian, B2 Level - Upper Intermediate

Filipino (Tagalog), B1 Level - Lower Intermediate

French (Canadian), B1 Level - Lower Intermediate

REFERENCES Available upon request.